Sourceline

Rollout Plan

27 October 2026

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This plan takes Sourceline from a working platform that nobody uses yet to fifteen business units running their procurement on it, starting with Fossil Contracting and Dokuma.

It also sets out what the group must provide before any of it can be considered the group's system rather than a demonstration. That section is first, because nothing else is safe to start without it.

Part 1 — What the group must provide

Sourceline currently runs on infrastructure that does not belong to the group. The domain is registered to another company, the hosting account is a personal one, and the database is on a free shared tier with no backups. That is appropriate for building and demonstrating a system. It is not appropriate for one holding the group's purchase orders, supplier bank details and payment records.

Everything below must be owned by the group, in the group's name, paid for by the group, with the group able to revoke any individual's access.

1.1 Why this matters

If it stays as it is	What happens
Domain registered to another company	The group's procurement system is reachable only while that registration is maintained and that company consents
Hosting on a personal account	One person's account closure, dispute or lapse takes down every unit
Database on a free shared tier	No automated backup. A loss is permanent. The tier also has a hard ceiling the system is close to
Secrets held by one individual	Nobody else can operate, restore or audit the system

None of these is a criticism of how it was built. They are the normal difference between a project and a system in service, and the transfer is the step that makes it the group's.

1.2 What is needed

Domain

A domain owned and registered by the group, not by a supplier or an individual. Each unit gets its own subdomain: `fossil.<group domain>`, `dokuma.<group domain>`, and so on. One wildcard DNS record covers all fifteen.

The group must hold the registrar account and control DNS. If the group already owns a domain, a subdomain of it works equally well — `procurement.<group domain>` with units beneath it.

Database

A managed MongoDB service, on the group's own account, on a paid tier.

Requirement	Why
Automated daily backups, with a stated retention period	A free tier has none. This is the single largest risk today
Point-in-time recovery	So a mistake can be undone to the minute, not the day
Encryption at rest	Supplier bank details are held

Requirement	Why
No shared collection ceiling	The current tier caps at 500 collections; production alone needs about 334
Separate clusters for production and for development and testing	Today they share one, so a test can exhaust production's capacity

A free tier cannot meet the first four. This is the one line item that cannot be economised without accepting that financial records may be lost permanently.

Hosting

Either keep the current hosting model on an account owned by the group, or host it on the group's own servers. Both work; they differ in cost and in who carries the operational burden.

	Managed hosting, group account	Group's own server
Setup	Hours	Days
Certificates	Automatic	Must be obtained and renewed
Scaling	Automatic	Manual
Needs	A billing account	A server, an operating system, a web server, a process manager, monitoring, patching
Suits	A group without dedicated infrastructure staff	A group with an IT team and a policy of hosting internally

If the group's policy is to host internally, the system runs on any Linux server with Node.js: the API as a long-running process behind a reverse proxy, the client as static files. Two modest servers, or one with both, plus the managed database.

Email

An account with a transactional email service, in the group's name, with the sending domain verified. The system sends sign-in codes, approval notifications and supplier invitations; without it, nobody can sign in once two-factor is on.

Accounts and access

#	Requirement
1	Every account — domain, database, hosting, email — created in the group's name with a group billing method
2	At least two named group administrators per account, so no single person is a point of failure
3	All secrets held in the group's password manager, not only in a deployment dashboard

#	Requirement
4	A named system owner and a deputy
5	Written confirmation that the group can revoke any individual's access without losing service

1.3 Handover checklist

#	Item	Done when
1	Group domain registered, DNS under group control	A unit's address resolves to the group's deployment
2	Paid database cluster on the group's account	A restore has been performed and timed
3	Separate cluster for development and testing	Production's capacity is unaffected by testing
4	Hosting on a group-owned account	A deploy runs from the group's account
5	Email service verified for the group's domain	A real sign-in code arrives
6	Secrets in the group's password manager	A second administrator can operate the system unaided
7	Code repository owned by the group	The group can grant and revoke developer access
8	System owner and deputy named	Both can perform the operations in the runbooks

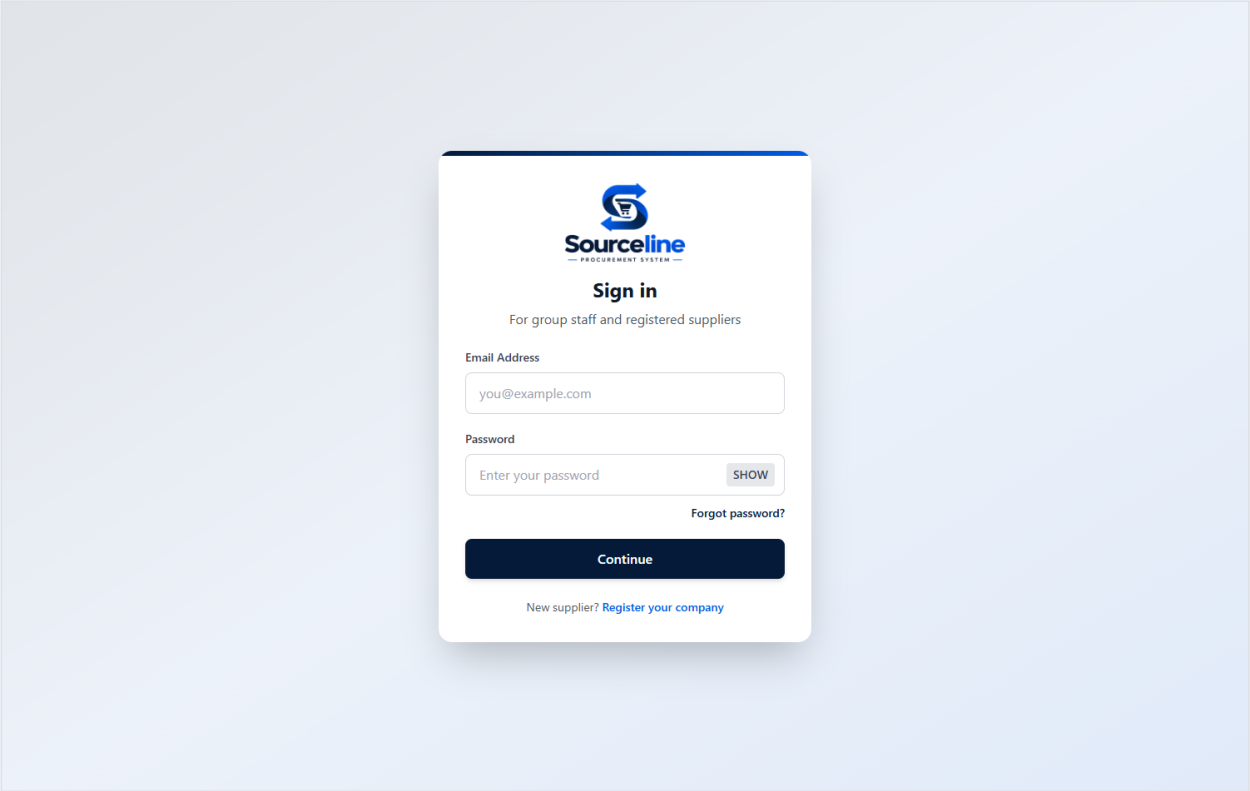
Until items 1 to 5 are complete, no business unit should process real purchases. Everything after this point assumes they are.

Part 2 — What the system does

A walkthrough of the main screens, so the plan can be read by someone who has not seen it.

2.1 Signing in

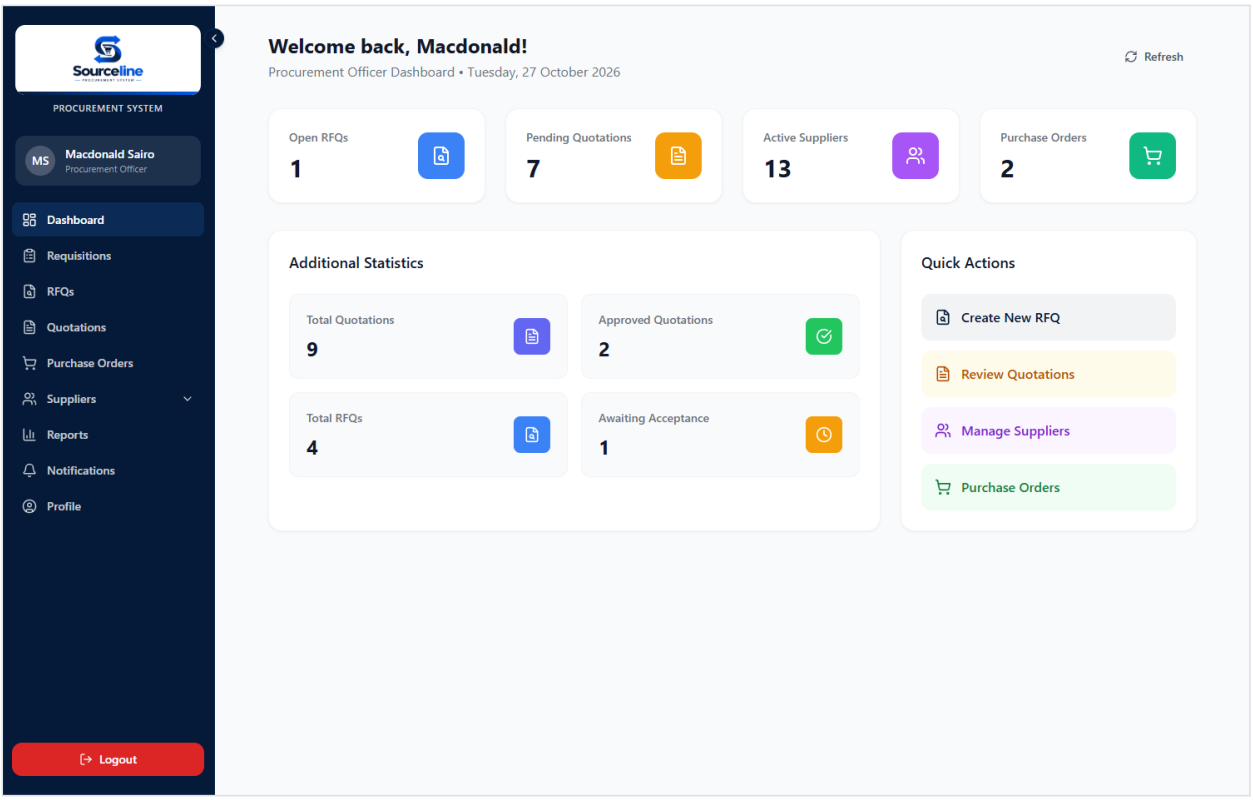
Each business unit has its own address. Opening it identifies the unit, so there is nothing to choose. Sign-in is email and password, then a six-digit code.



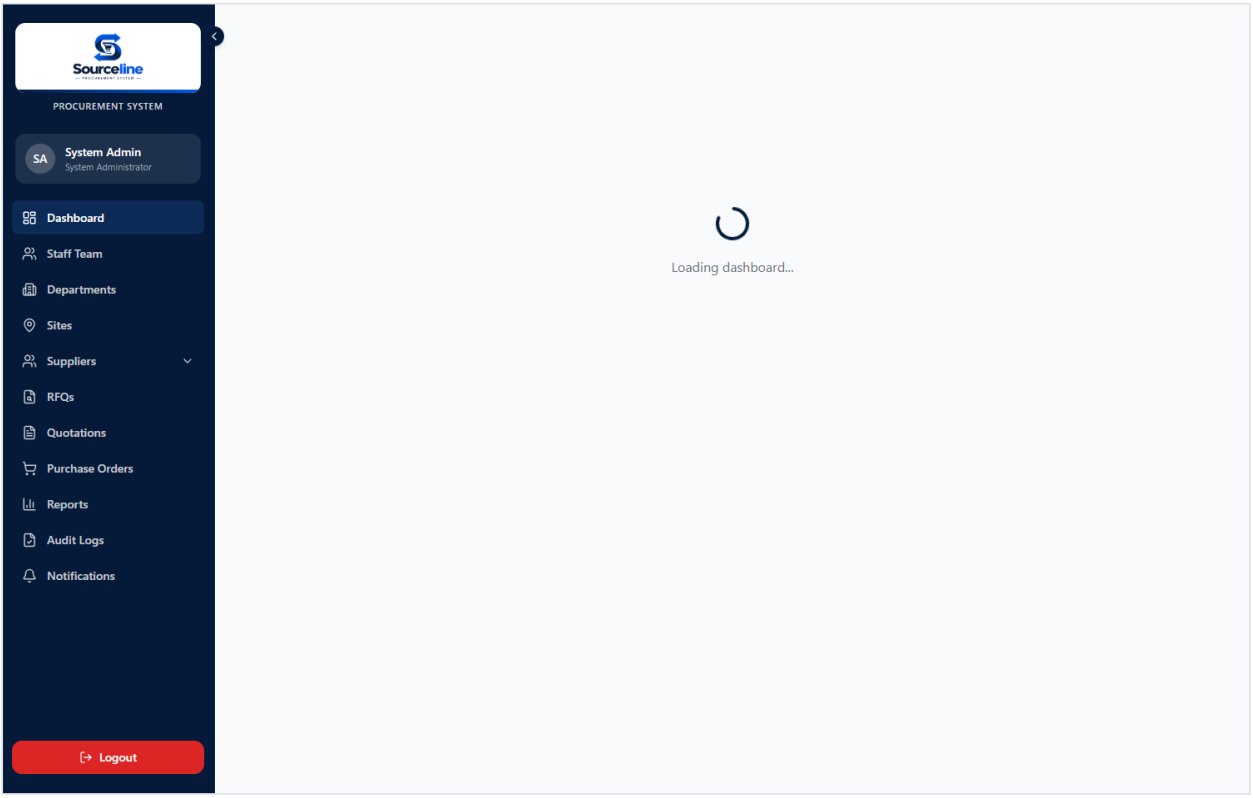
The login page at a business unit's own address. No unit chooser — the address already determined it. Suppliers register themselves through the link at the bottom.

2.2 Dashboards

Every role sees a dashboard built for what that role does. The procurement officer sees sourcing in progress; finance sees what is awaiting approval; an end user sees their own requests.



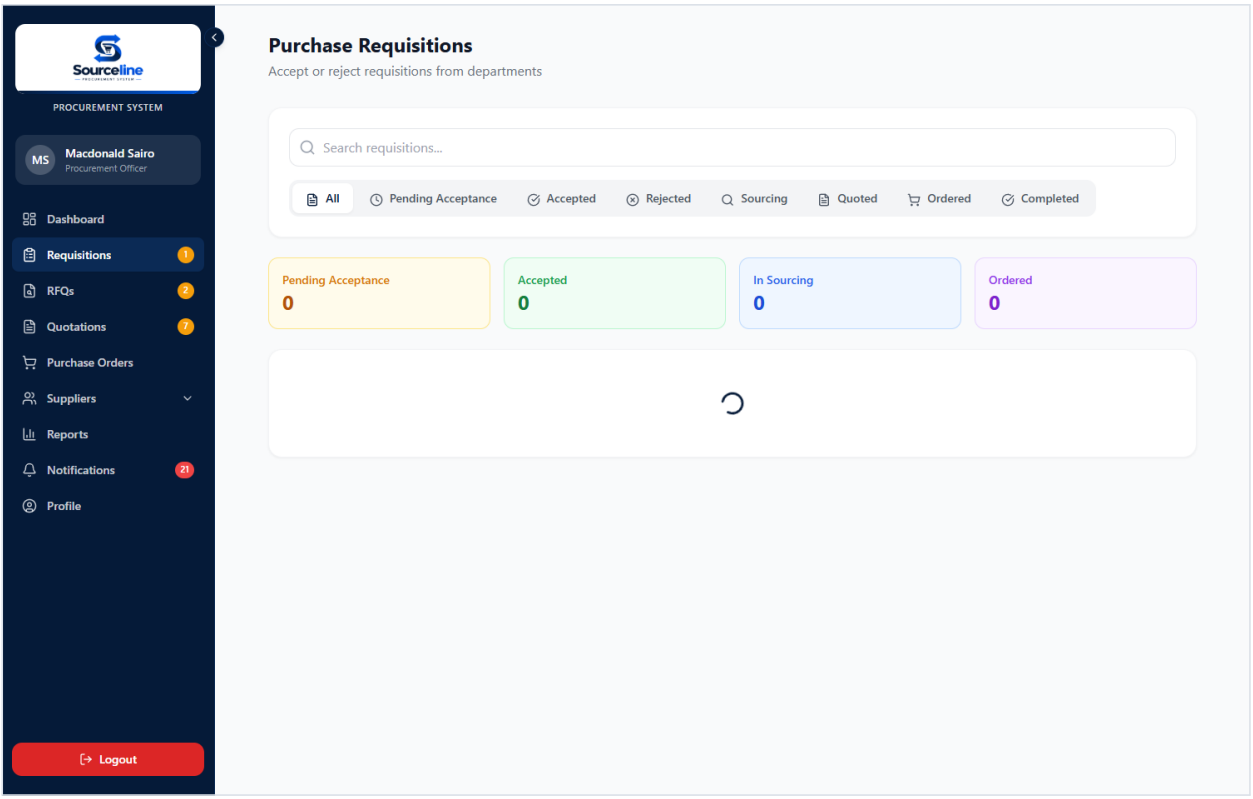
The procurement officer's dashboard, showing what is in flight and what needs attention.



The administrator's dashboard: users, suppliers, open RFQs, orders pending approval, and a system overview.

2.3 Requisitions

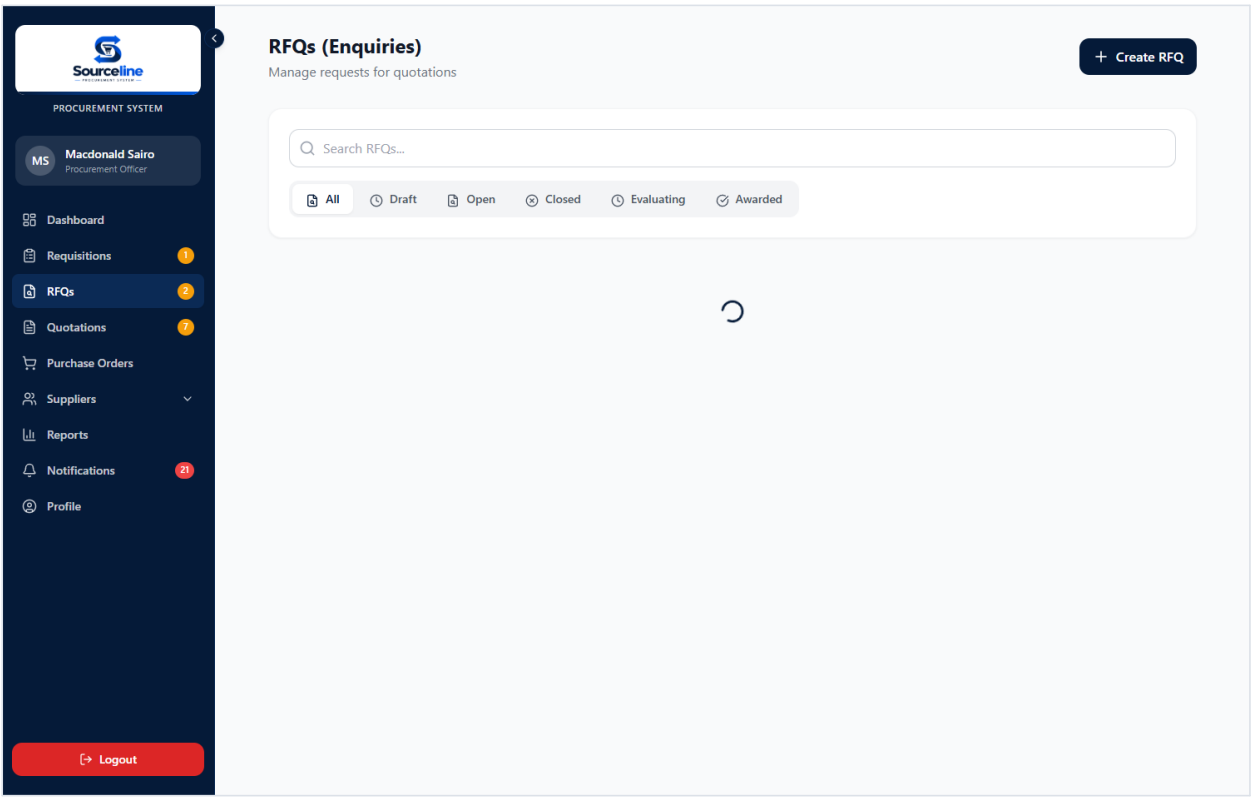
Anyone can raise a requisition. It is approved by their department head, checked against stock by stores, then accepted by procurement for sourcing.



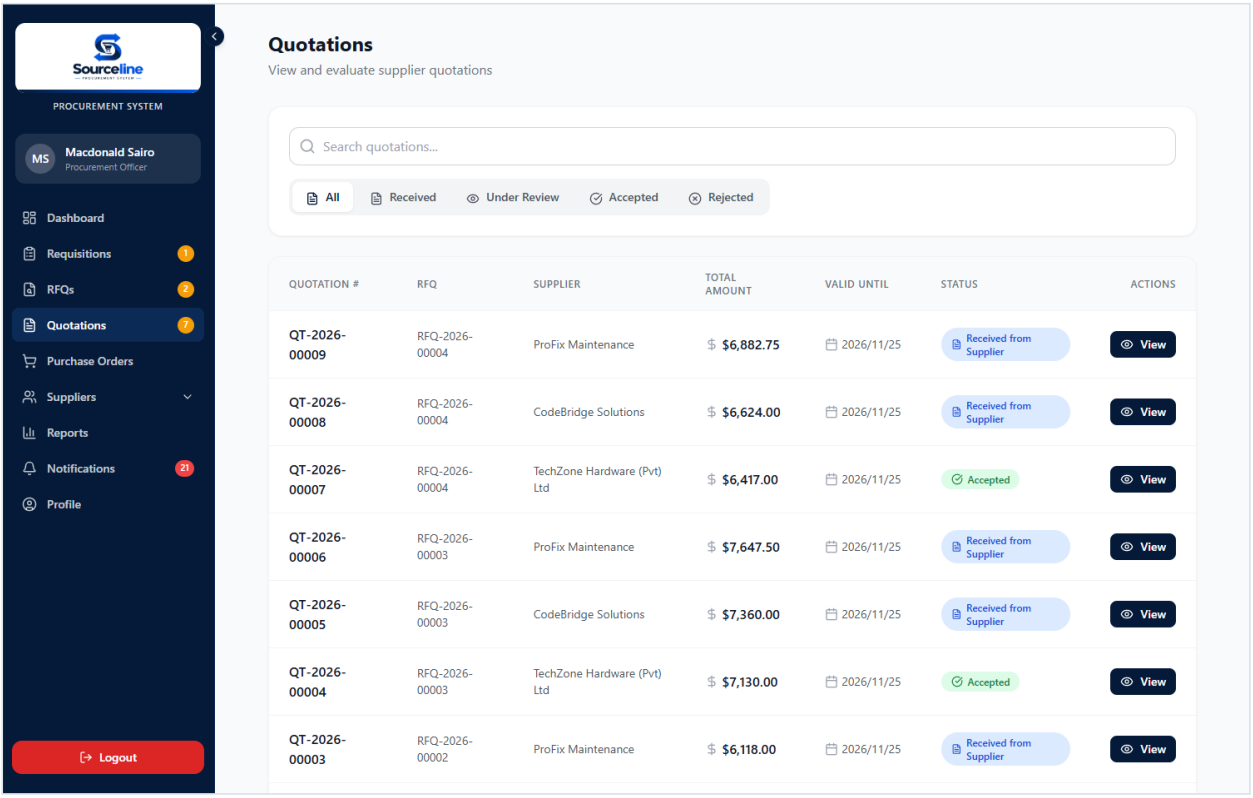
Requisitions, filtered by where they are in the process.

2.4 Sourcing — RFQs and quotations

Procurement publishes a request for quotation to invited suppliers. Suppliers quote through their own sign-in. The department head selects a winner and must record why.



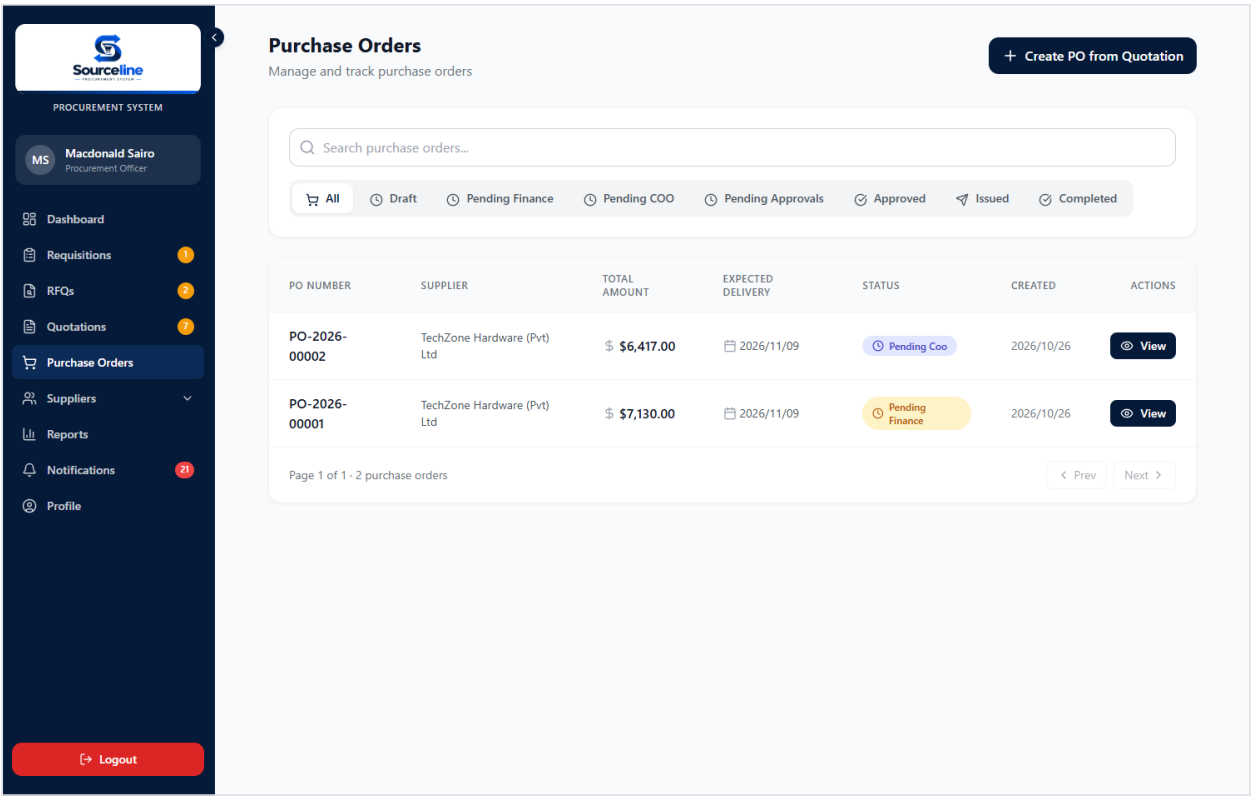
Requests for quotation, with their status and deadlines.



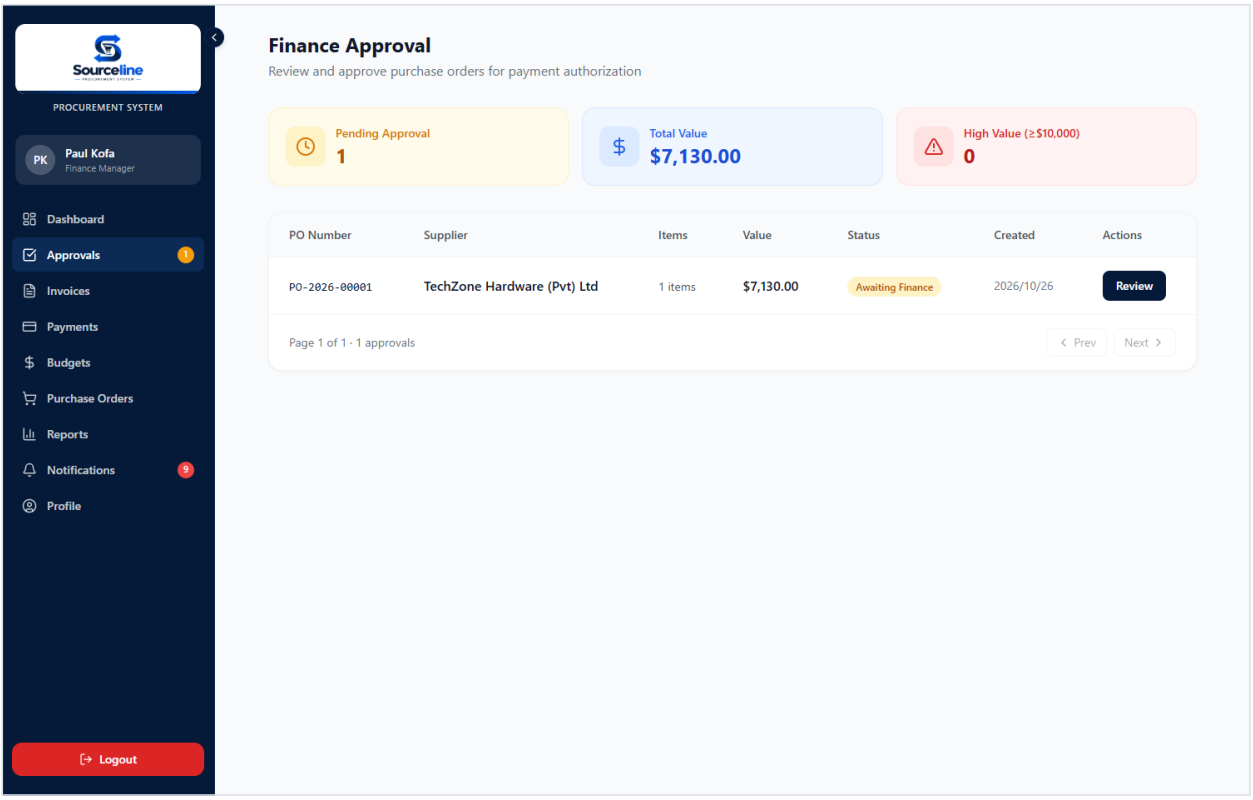
Quotations received, so prices can be compared side by side before an award.

2.5 Purchase orders and approvals

A purchase order is raised from the accepted quotation, then approved by the requesting department head, the head of Procurement, Finance, and — above the threshold — the COO.



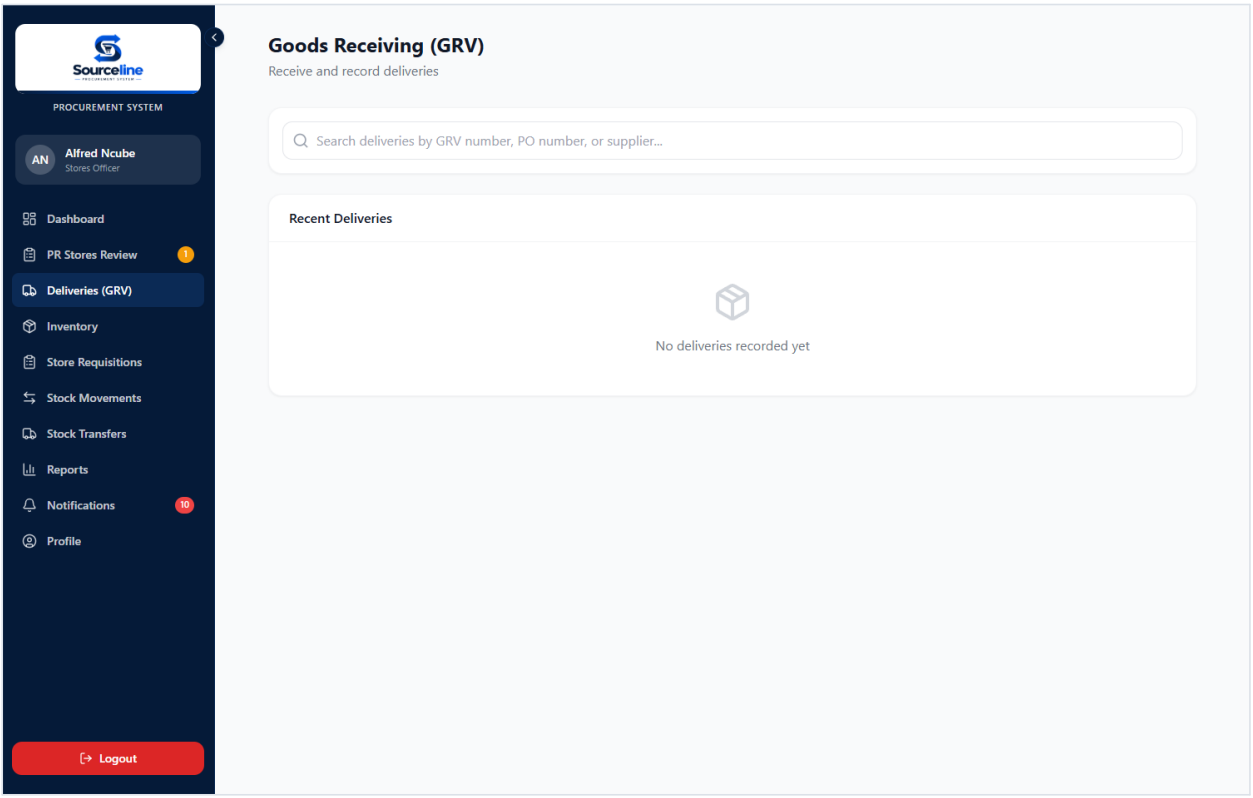
Purchase orders with their approval status. PO-2026-00001 is awaiting Finance; PO-2026-00002 is above the threshold and awaiting the COO.



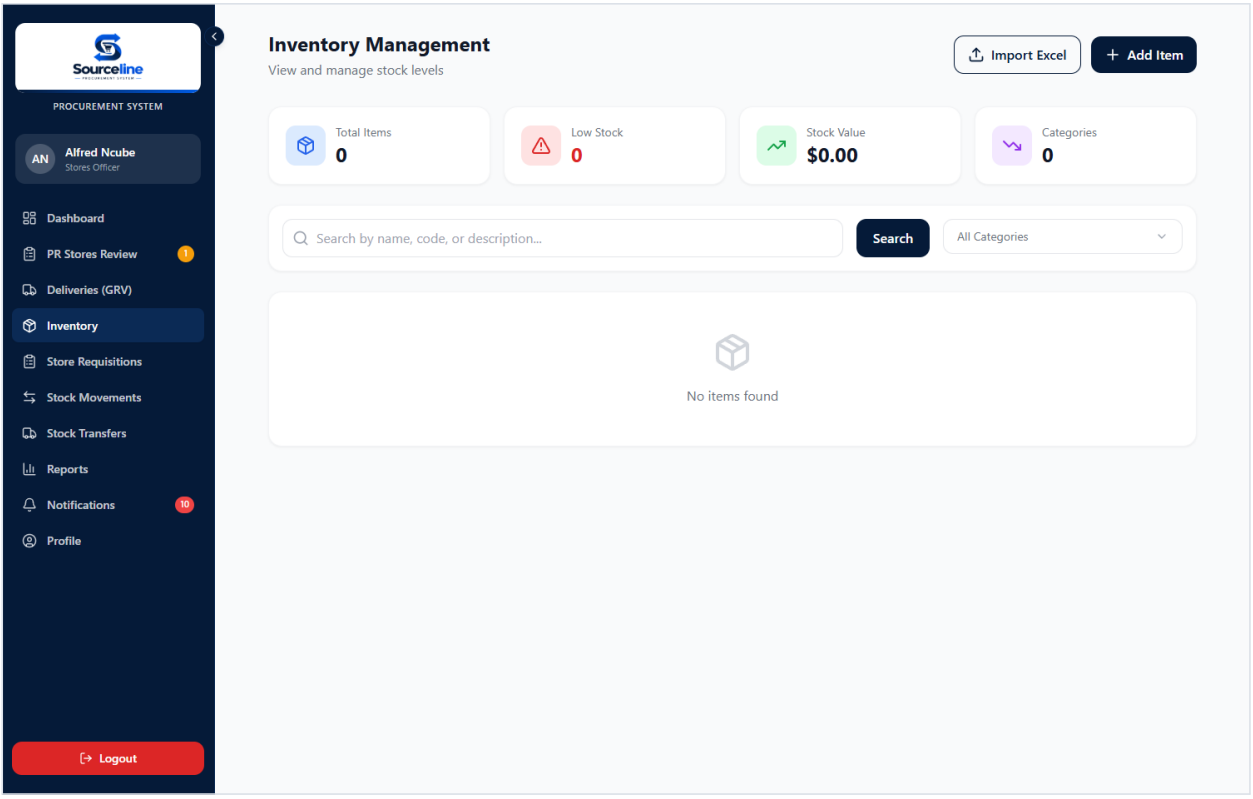
Finance's approval queue.

2.6 Goods receipt and stores

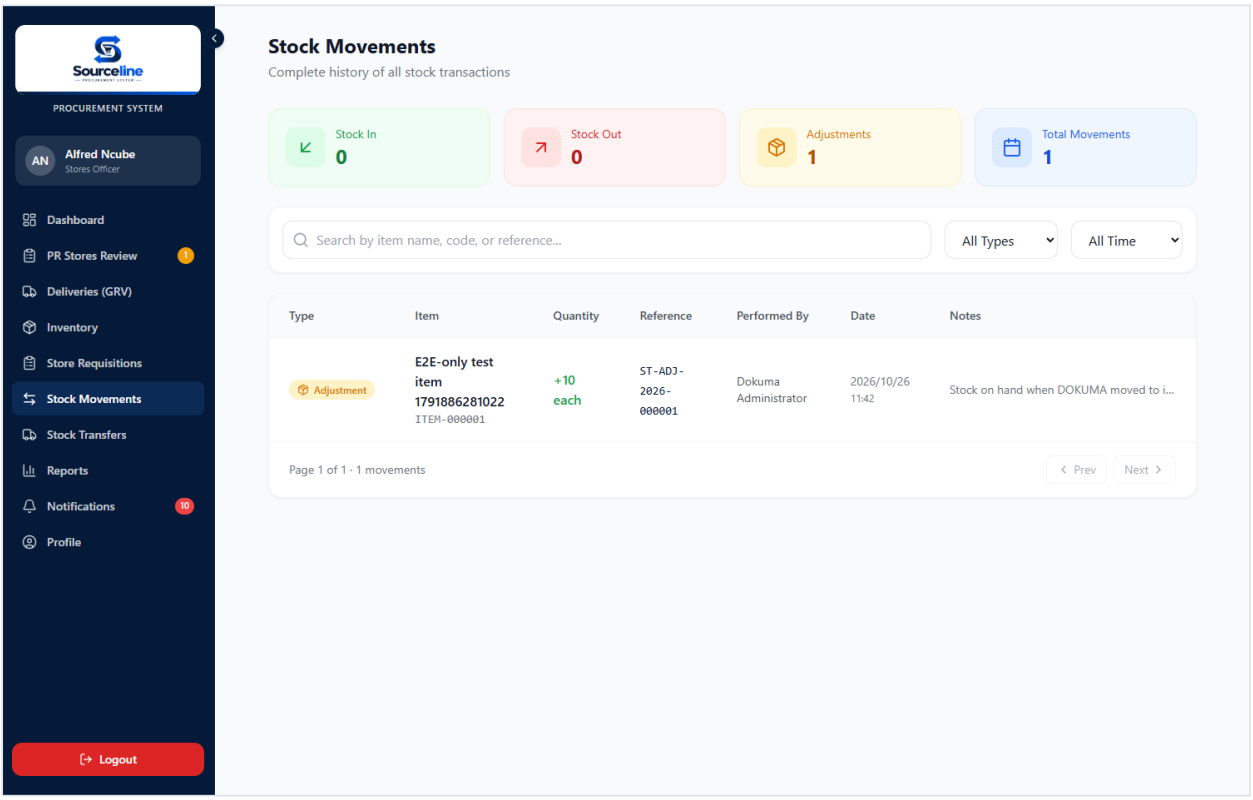
Stores records what physically arrived, accepts it into stock or rejects it. Stock, movements and transfers between sites are tracked.



Goods received notes.



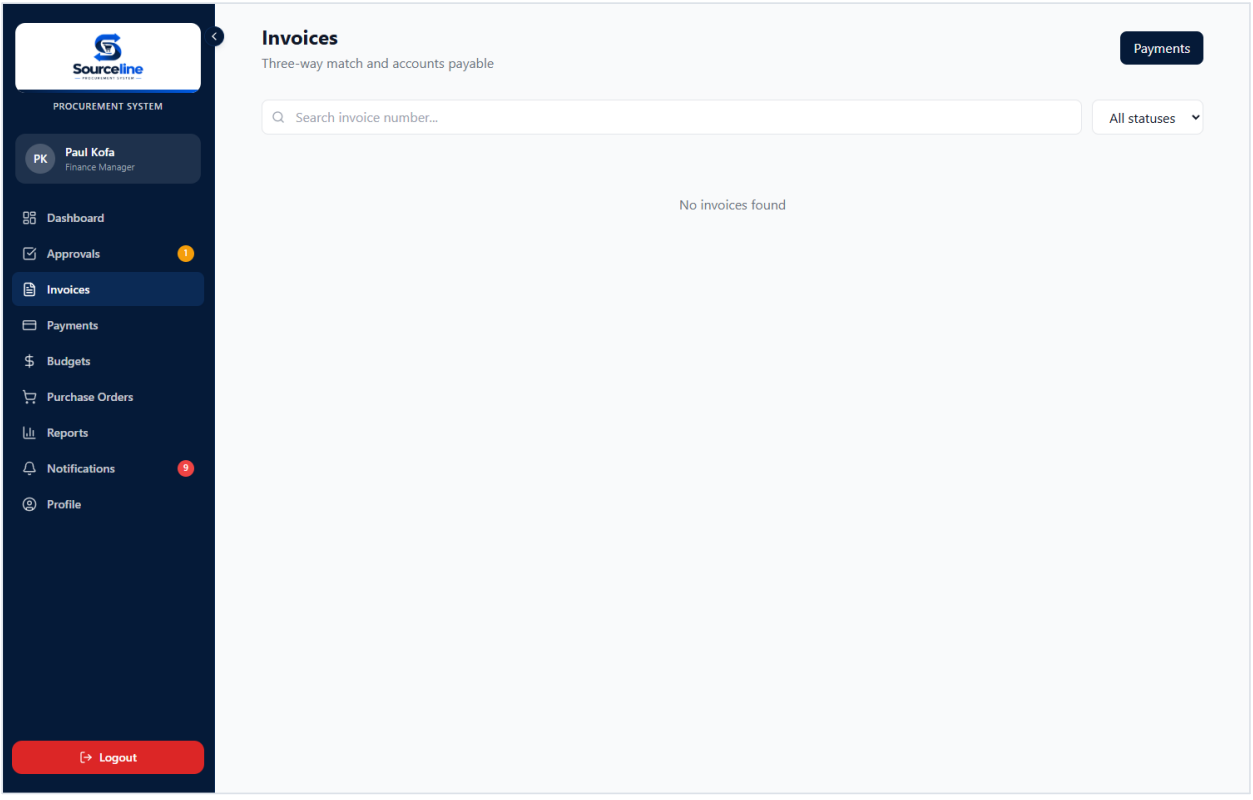
Stock on hand by site, with reorder levels.



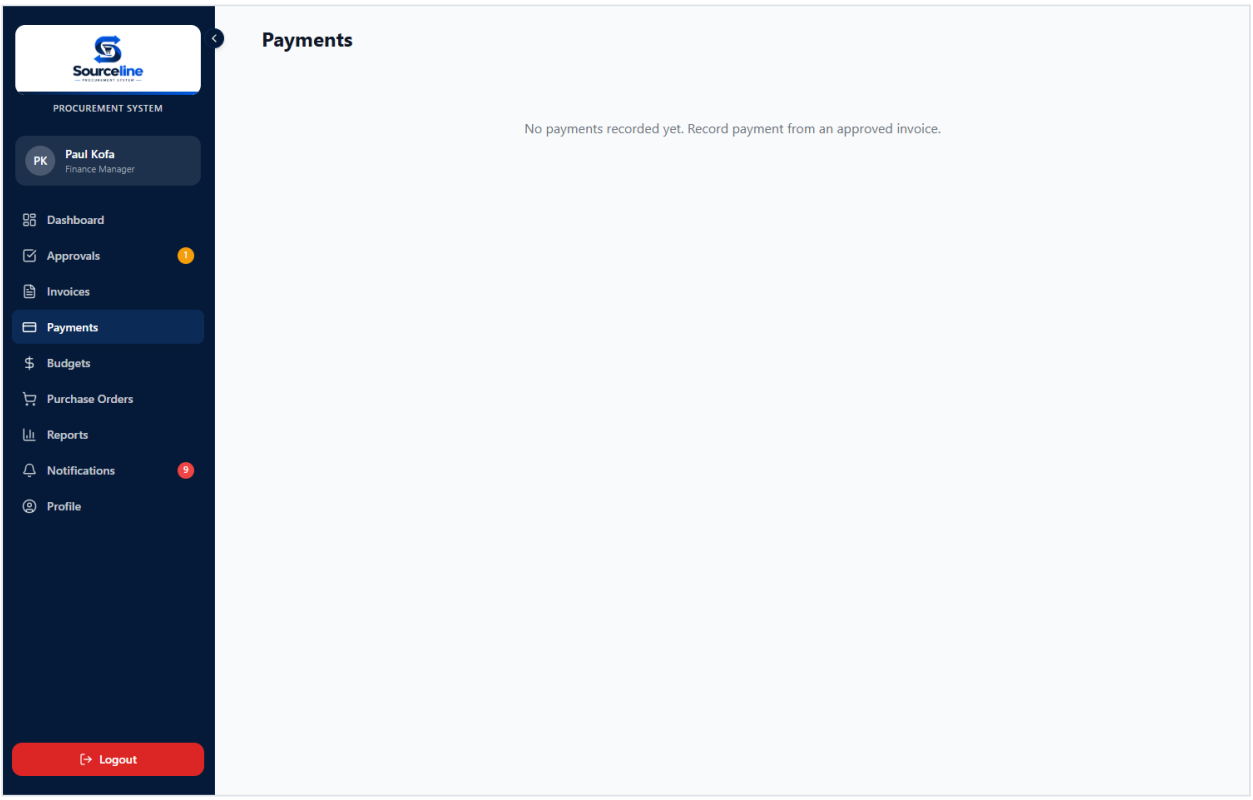
Stock movements — every issue, receipt and adjustment.

2.7 Invoices, payments and budgets

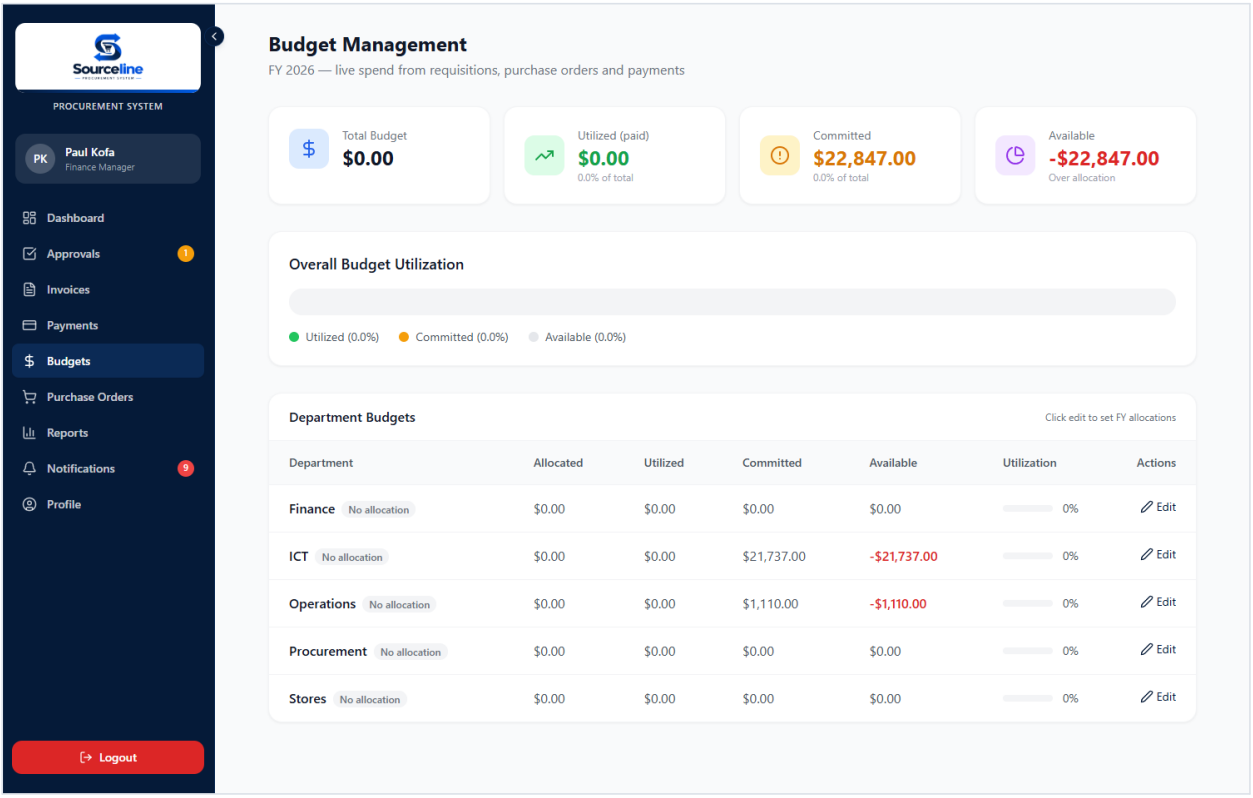
A supplier invoices against the order. The invoice is matched against the order and against what stores actually receipted before finance can approve it.



Supplier invoices awaiting matching and approval.



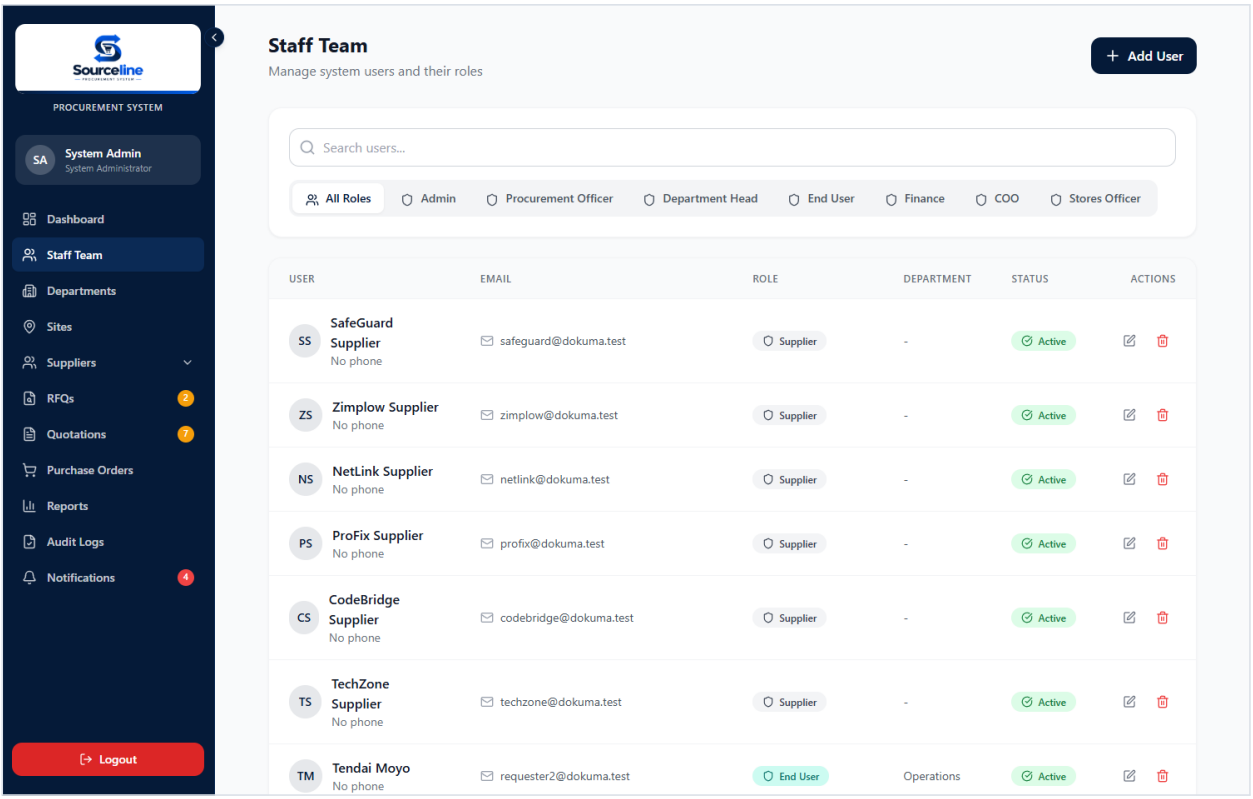
Payments recorded against approved invoices.



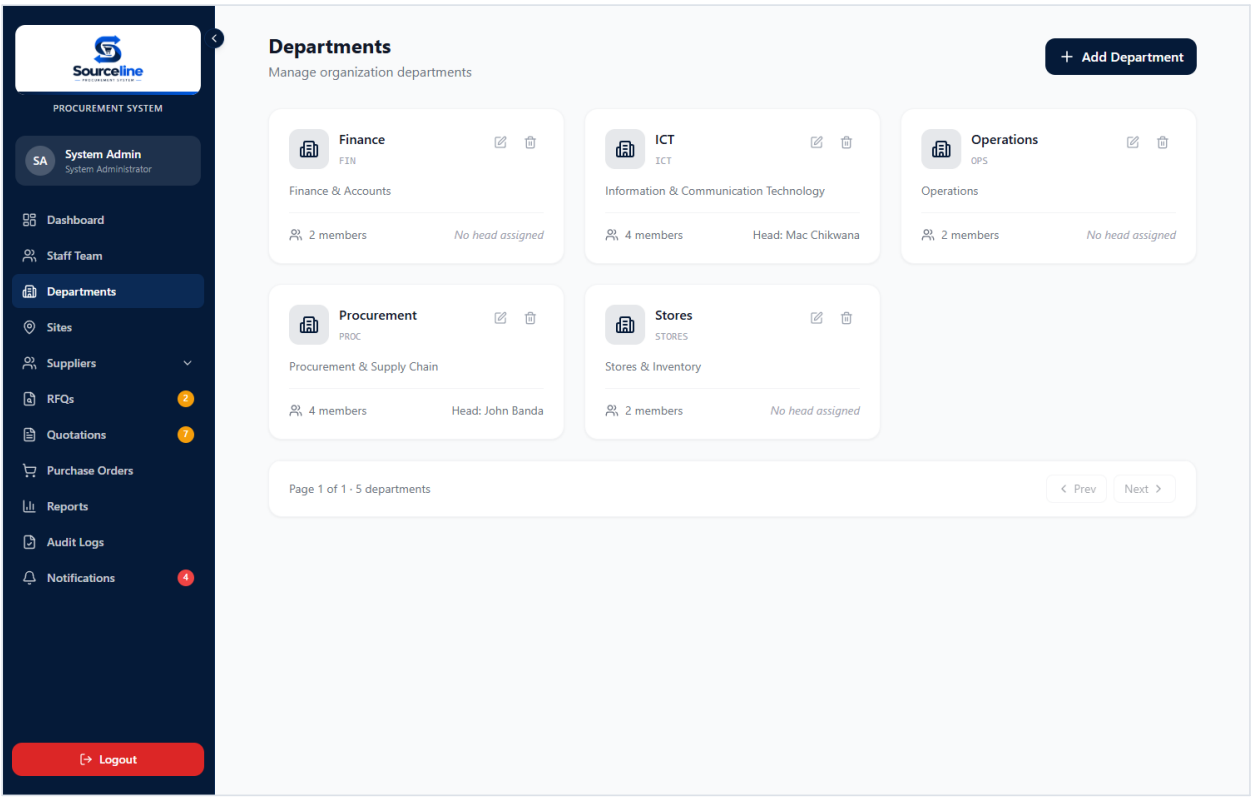
Department budgets and what has been committed against them.

2.8 Administration and audit

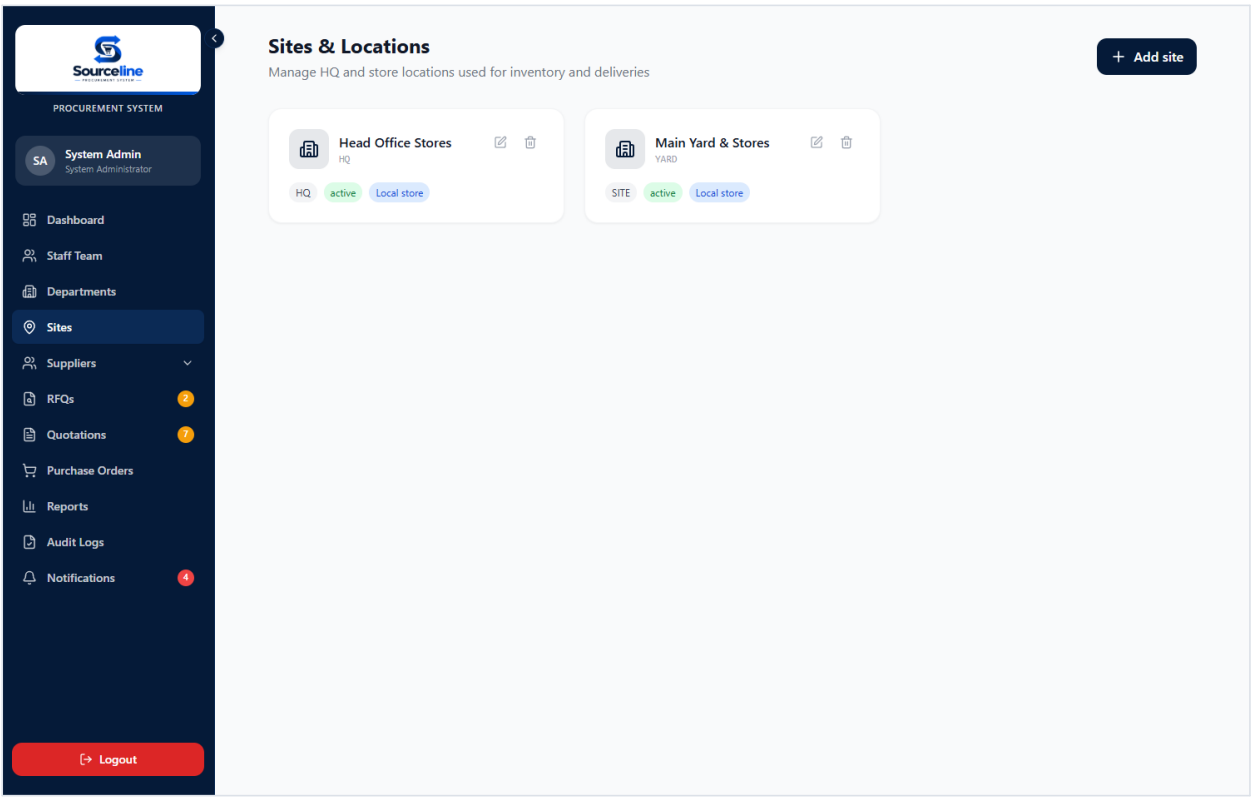
Administrators manage users, departments and sites. Every significant action is recorded and the record survives a data reset.



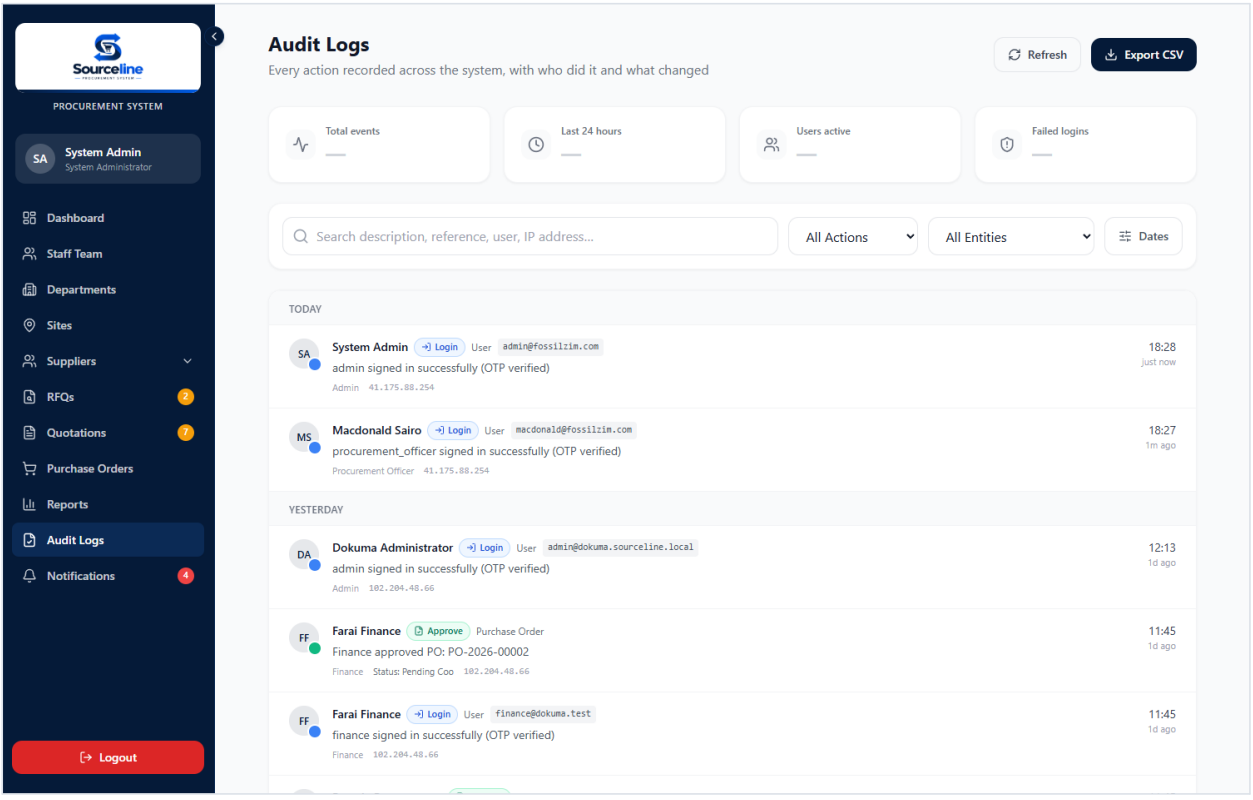
Staff and their roles.



Departments.



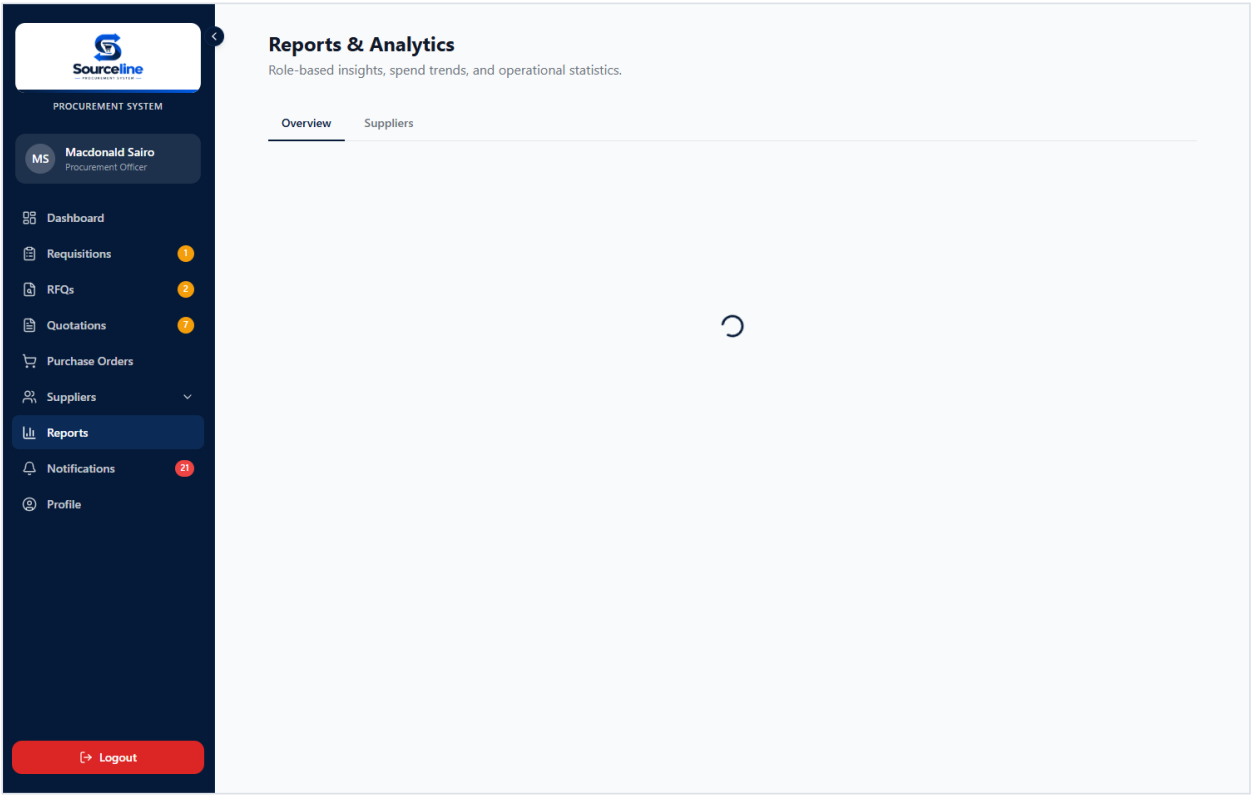
Sites.



The audit log — who did what, and when.

2.9 Reporting

Supplier performance, due diligence completeness, evaluation scores and spend.



Reports, including supplier performance and compliance.

2.10 The controls, in short

These are what the system is for.

Control	What it enforces
Three quotations before an award	Fewer requires a recorded waiver naming a reason from a fixed list
An approval chain that lengthens with value	Department head, Procurement head, Finance, and the COO above USD 5,000
Three-way match before payment	The invoice must agree with the order and with what stores actually receipted
Supplier eligibility	A supplier may be invited to quote while diligence is in progress, but cannot be awarded until it is complete and spend-authorised
Separation between units	Each unit has its own database; a session in one is refused by another

Part 3 — The rollout

3.1 Where things stand

	Status
Fifteen units deployed, own addresses, valid certificates	Done
Unit identified by address; sessions cannot cross units	Done and verified
Full procurement cycle, 50 steps, against live production	Passed
Infrastructure owned by the group	**No — see Part 1**
Database backups	**No**
Units populated with real data	Only Dokuma, and only with test data
Administrator accounts able to receive email	No — addresses are not real
Two-factor sign-in	Switched off

3.2 Principles

Fossil and Dokuma first, both all the way. Two units teach more than one — the first proves the process works, the second proves it transfers. Both complete before any third unit starts.

A unit is live only when a real purchase completes in it. Not when accounts exist.

Stop if the pilot teaches something. The point of a pilot is to change the plan.

Nothing irreversible without a backup. Part 1 before Part 3.

3.3 Phase 0 — Infrastructure and blockers

Nothing starts until these are done.

#	Task	Owner	Done when
0.1	Complete the handover checklist in 1.3	Group IT, Technical	All eight items signed off
0.2	Restore a backup into a scratch environment and time it	Technical	A restore has actually been performed
0.3	Move the units to the group's domain	Technical	Each unit resolves at a group address
0.4	Deploy the pending dashboard fix	Technical	Department heads outside Procurement can load their dashboard
0.5	Real administrator addresses, real passwords	Business, Technical	A password reset email arrives

#	Task	Owner	Done when
0.6	Switch two-factor sign-in on	Technical	A real emailed code is required
0.7	Correct the client address used in emails	Technical	A notification links to a working address

Exit test. An administrator signs out, requests a password reset, receives the email, resets, and signs back in with a real emailed code — on a group-owned address.

Until 0.6 is done, anyone who knows an email address can sign in as that person, finance included. Acceptable for testing; not for live purchasing.

3.4 Phase 1 — Fossil and Dokuma

Both units, in parallel, real people, real purchases, three weeks.

Fossil is the original business and carries the most history and expectation. Dokuma is a clean start. Running them together surfaces both the migration questions and the greenfield ones at the same time, while the team is still close to the work.

Prepare, per unit

#	Task	Owner
1.1	Clear test data from the unit	Technical
1.2	Create real sites and departments	Unit admin
1.3	Create real users, one per role, real addresses	Unit admin
1.4	Onboard real suppliers with diligence completed	Procurement
1.5	Load the catalogue and opening stock balances	Stores
1.6	Set department budgets	Finance
1.7	**Confirm the approval threshold and chain match the unit's real delegation of authority**	Finance, COO
1.8	Train each role, using the unit's own data	Business

Item 1.7 is the one most often skipped and most expensive to find later. The system enforces USD 5,000 and a four-stage chain because that is how it was built. If a unit's real authority limits differ, it will enforce the wrong rule faithfully.

Fossil has an additional question: what happens to purchases already in progress, and to historical records. The recommendation in 3.7 is that in-flight work finishes in the old process.

Run

Both units process real procurement through Sourceline for three weeks. The old process stays available as a fallback but is not run in parallel — doing both doubles the work and guarantees neither is trusted.

Exit tests, each unit

1. At least ten real requisitions have reached payment.
2. At least one purchase above the threshold has passed all four approvals.
3. At least one invoice has been correctly refused for goods not receipted.
4. Stock figures agree with a physical count.
5. Finance confirms the budget figures match their own records.
6. The separation checks in 3.6 pass between the two units.
7. No unresolved issue rated urgent.

Decide

Hold a review. Proceed, proceed after fixes, or stop. Write down which and why.

3.5 Phases 2 to 4

Phase 2 — three units, two weeks. Khayah Cement, Titan and Kurima Centre. Chosen because they differ from each other and from the pilot pair: a cement producer, a services business, a retailer.

Phase 3 — the remaining seven Zimbabwean units, four weeks. Mandfar, Masimba, Persimmon, ProPlastics, Rhopower, The Grain Hub, Trends. Two a week, using the checklist.

Phase 4 — the three South African units. Enviro Plastic, Mangethe, Thando Kinetics. These need work the others do not: South African supplier compliance and ZAR. Currency is not yet carried on orders, invoices or payments, so Phase 4 depends on that being built. It is deliberately left undated.

The per-unit checklist

#	Step	Owner
1	Confirm the unit's address resolves and serves over HTTPS	Technical
2	Build the unit's indexes	Technical
3	Real administrator address and password	Technical
4	Sites and departments	Unit admin
5	Users, one per role, real addresses	Unit admin
6	Confirm the approval chain against the unit's delegation of authority	Unit finance

#	Step	Owner
7	Suppliers onboarded, diligence complete, spend-authorised	Unit procurement
8	Catalogue and opening stock	Unit stores
9	Department budgets	Unit finance
10	Train each role	Business
11	One complete purchase as a rehearsal	Unit
12	Confirm the unit sees no other unit's data	Technical

3.6 Separation checks, each time a unit goes live

Run against every pair of live units. A leak found after four units are live is four times the problem.

- A session opened in one unit is refused by another.
- A supplier added in one does not appear in the other.
- Document numbers restart per unit — expected, not a collision.
- A user of one unit cannot sign in at another's address.

3.7 Cutover and fallback

Cutover is per unit. A unit switches when its rehearsal passes.

In-flight work stays where it started. Purchases already under way finish in the old process. Sourceline takes new requisitions only. Migrating half-finished purchases is more error-prone than letting them drain.

Fallback is the old process for that unit alone, available for the first month. The trigger is a defect that stops purchasing with no workaround within a day.

3.8 Training

One session per role, not per unit.

Audience	Length	Covers
End users	15 min	Raise a requisition, track it, read notifications
Department heads	30 min	Approve requisitions and orders, select a winner with justification
Procurement	60 min	Sourcing, RFQs, award, orders, supplier diligence
Finance	45 min	Order approval, three-way match, invoices, payments, budgets

Audience	Length	Covers
Stores	45 min	Stock checks, receipt, acceptance and rejection, transfers
COO	15 min	Authorising above the threshold, and what the figures mean
Suppliers	20 min	Registering, diligence, quoting, acknowledging, invoicing

Supplier training is the one usually forgotten. Suppliers who cannot quote get chased by telephone, and the competitive-quotation control quietly lapses.

3.9 Risks

Risk	Consequence	What reduces it
Infrastructure stays on personal accounts	The group's records depend on an individual's account	Part 1, before anything
No database backup when the first real purchase is recorded	Unrecoverable loss of financial records	Phase 0.1 and 0.2
Approval thresholds do not match real delegated authority	The wrong rule enforced faithfully, on real money	Step 6 of the checklist
Suppliers do not use the portal	Quotes collected by telephone; the competitive control lapses	Supplier training; monitor quotes per RFQ
Units go live before the pilot is reviewed	One defect repeated fifteen times	Phase gates and the authority to stop
The shared cluster reaches its ceiling	Writes fail in every unit, production included	A separate cluster for testing

3.10 Indicative timeline

Assumes the infrastructure handover is prompt and the pilot does not force a change of plan.

Phase	Duration	Cumulative
0 — Infrastructure handover and blockers	2 weeks	Week 2
1 — Fossil and Dokuma	3 weeks	Week 5
Review and fixes	1 week	Week 6
2 — Three units	2 weeks	Week 8

Phase	Duration	Cumulative
3 — Seven Zimbabwean units	4 weeks	Week 12
4 — South African units	Depends on currency support	—

Twelve units live in about twelve weeks. Phase 4 is unscheduled because it depends on work not yet built, and a date would be a guess presented as a plan.

Phase 0 is two weeks rather than one because it now includes the infrastructure handover, most of which is waiting on accounts, billing approvals and DNS rather than on work.